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DWG Cleaner

Turn heavy DWG drawings into clean, light
Vectorworks files with real symbols.

User manual

Beta test edition

Version 1.0.43

September 2026

For

Vectorworks 2025 and 2026 on Mac

1 What DWG Cleaner does

Suppliers send DWG files from BricsCAD or AutoCAD in which every copy of an LED tile, truss part or bracket is its own nested group. Vectorworks then converts every single copy, which makes the file slow and heavy, and none of it becomes a symbol.

DWG Cleaner fixes this before and after Vectorworks imports the drawing:

- **Prepare:** on your Mac, it finds identical 3D parts and repeated blocks and turns them into symbols, so Vectorworks converts each shape only once.
- **Review:** it shows you every symbol with a preview, so you can name it and choose how much detail it keeps.
- **Import and clean:** it opens Vectorworks, imports the drawing, removes empty and single-object groups and tiny leftovers, and saves a `.vwx` next to the original. The original DWG is never changed or overwritten.

2 Before you start

You need the following on your Mac. Everything else, including Python, is built into DWG Cleaner, and it checks all of this when it starts.

WHAT	WHY AND WHERE TO GET IT
A Mac with Apple silicon (M1 or later), macOS 14 or later	This beta is built for Apple silicon only.
A More To Show account	Your @moretoshow.com Microsoft 365 account, to sign in.
Vectorworks 2025 or 2026	Installed in <code>/Applications</code> , as usual.
ODA File Converter	Free. It reads the DWG for the Prepare step. Download it from opendesign.com (the app's Check Setup... window has a link) and drag it to <code>/Applications</code> .

3 Install and first launch

- 1 Open the disk image and drag **More To Show - DWG Cleaner** to the **Applications** folder.
 - 2 Open it from Applications. Because this beta is not signed by Apple, macOS stops it the first time. Open **System Settings** › **Privacy & Security**, scroll down and click **Open Anyway** next to DWG Cleaner, then confirm. You only do this once.
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- 3 **Sign in.** The start screen shows the More To Show logo and **Sign in with Microsoft**. Click it and choose your **@moretoshow.com** account; only More To Show accounts can use the app. After that it opens straight away. It checks your account with Microsoft once a day, and keeps working offline for up to two weeks. To switch account, use **DWG Cleaner › Sign Out**.
- 4 If something is missing, the **Setup** window opens by itself. It lists Vectorworks, ODA File Converter and Python 3 with a status for each (Python 3 says **Built into the app**). For ODA File Converter, click **Open Download Page**, download the **macOS** version, open it and drag **ODAFFileConverter** to Applications. Then click **Check Again** and **Done**. You can open this window any time with **DWG Cleaner › Check Setup....**
- 5 The first time DWG Cleaner starts Vectorworks, macOS asks whether it may control Vectorworks. Click **OK**. If you clicked **Don't Allow** by mistake, turn it on again in **System Settings › Privacy & Security › Automation**.

Updates come by themselves

DWG Cleaner checks for a new version once a day and offers to install it; click **Install Update** and it restarts with the new version. You can also check any time with **DWG Cleaner › Check for Updates....**

4 Converting a drawing, step by step

- 1 **Close** the drawing in Vectorworks if you converted it before. Vectorworks can't save over a file that is open.
- 2 **Drop the DWG** (or DXF) on the DWG Cleaner window, or click **Choose Files....** You can add several drawings; they are done one after the other.
- 3 **Check the Settings** on the right: the Vectorworks version, the template for the new file (Blank Metric by default) and where to save (next to the original by default). The default options are a good start; section 6 explains each one.
- 4 Keep **Clean up & save** selected and click the big button (**Clean Up 1 Drawing**). DWG Cleaner prepares the drawing. That takes seconds to a minute.
- 5 **The symbol review opens.** Name the symbols and check the detail (section 5), then click **Import into Vectorworks**.
- 6 **Let Vectorworks work.** DWG Cleaner shows each phase and an estimate of the time left. Don't use Vectorworks meanwhile. If the status says Vectorworks is idle and probably waiting for you, switch to Vectorworks: it is showing a dialog, usually the import options. Click **OK** there and the run carries on.
- 7 **Done.** The window lists the symbols and what was cleaned. Click **Show .vwx in Finder**, open the file in Vectorworks and finish with **Tools › Purge**.

Nothing is overwritten

DWG Cleaner always saves a new file: name.vwx , or name 2.vwx , name 3.vwx ... when that exists already.

The file opens in Top/Plan

DWG Cleaner does not change the view: every attempt to do so from the app crashed Vectorworks. Switch to a 3D view yourself (for example **View › Standard Views › Right Isometric**, then Fit to Objects).

5 The symbol review

Between the Prepare step and the import you see every symbol-to-be, heaviest first. Each row has a shaded preview (click it for a larger view), a name, its size and number of copies, a bar showing its share of what Vectorworks will have to draw, and the detail choice on the right. The footer shows how many faces Vectorworks will draw with your choices.

What to do

- 1 **Name the main symbols**, such as the LED tile or a rigging assembly, the way they should appear in the Resource Manager. Rows marked **Part of ...** become part of the symbol above them and need no name.
- 2 **Leave the detail on Full** unless the file must be lighter (see below).
- 3 Click **Import into Vectorworks**. **Cancel** stops without importing anything.

The detail choices

Full

The part exactly as drawn. Always correct; the heaviest.

Simple

Rebuilt as a Vectorworks extrude of its outline: much lighter, but small details drop out and round tubes become square. Check the preview first.

Box

A block of the same size. For parts you only need as a volume.

Leave out

The part is not imported at all.

Round parts

Pipes, tubes and ladders lose their round shape as Simple. The **Simplify all** and

Simplify the ... suggested parts buttons skip parts that are mostly round, but they can miss some.

For example, the round tubes of an LED tile's back frame still come out square. When in doubt, keep a part on Full.

Names are remembered. A name you type is stored with the shape of the symbol. When the same shape turns up in a later drawing, it gets your name automatically. Detail choices are not remembered; every drawing starts on Full.

6 The options

OPTION	DEFAULT	WHAT IT DOES
Prepare the DWG first	On	Merges identical 3D parts and names repeated blocks on your Mac before Vectorworks sees the file. Strongly recommended for 3D drawings; needs ODA File Converter.
Review and name the symbols before importing	On	Shows the symbol review (section 5).
Simplify the parts into Vectorworks extrudes	Off	Starts the review with every part on Simple (round parts stay Full). Makes files much lighter but less exact.
Treat near-identical assemblies as one symbol	On	Merges assemblies that differ by at most 1 mm and 1°. That tight, nothing moves.
Import heavy parts in a second pass	Off	Saves the drawing after a quick first pass, then adds the heaviest solids.
Also import the paper-space layouts	Off	Brings the DWG's sheets in as sheet layers. Much slower: their viewports redraw the whole 3D model.
Remove single-object and empty groups	On	Removes the extra group levels CAD programs wrap around every component.
Turn repeated parts into symbols	On	Repeated parts become symbols in the Resource Manager folder DWG Components .
Remove objects smaller than	5 mm	Deletes tiny leftovers (longest side below the limit). Texts, dimensions and loci are always kept. Set it to 0 to keep everything.
Clean up & save / Only analyse	Clean up	Only analyse imports and reports what it would do, and saves nothing.

The link **...or clean up the drawing already open in Vectorworks** cleans a drawing you imported yourself. It does not import or save anything.

7 Known limits of this beta

- A drawing takes from a minute to much longer, depending on how many 3D solids it has. Vectorworks does the DWG import on one processor core, so a faster Mac helps only a little.
- Vectorworks sometimes crashes while the app drives it. Your DWG is never at risk, and a drawing that was already saved stays saved. Please send the crash report (section 8).

- On one test drawing, a row of LED tiles was missing after the import, although it was present in the prepared file. If you see missing objects, tell us which ones.
- 2D plan views for the symbols (hybrid symbols) are not available yet: a DWG can't carry them into Vectorworks.

8 Beta test: what to try and what to send

Please try

- ☐ Install and set up on your Mac (sections 2 and 3). Note anything that was unclear.
- ☐ Convert a small DWG with default settings.
- ☐ Convert a heavy 3D DWG from a supplier (LED walls, truss, set pieces).
- ☐ In the review: name the main symbols, try Simple or Box on one heavy part and compare the result.
- ☐ Convert the same kind of drawing again and check that your names come back.
- ☐ Open the result in Vectorworks: are the symbols right? Is anything missing, moved or the wrong shape? Is the file quick to work with?

When something goes wrong, send

- A screenshot of DWG Cleaner and, if relevant, of Vectorworks showing the problem.
- The version number, shown under **DWG Cleaner › About DWG Cleaner**.
- If Vectorworks crashed: the crash report. In Finder choose **Go › Go to Folder...**, paste `~/Library/Logs/DiagnosticReports` and send the newest file whose name starts with `Vectorworks`.
- If you can share it, the DWG itself (or tell us where it is in Dropbox).

Send it all to Jordi: **jordi@moretoshow.com**. Please keep the app and this manual inside More To Show; they are internal tools.